Easy RX Cycle

FREE GUIDE · FOR MEDICAL CANNABIS OPERATORS

The Medical Cannabis Guide to DEA-Compliant Disposal.

Schedule III, DEA registration, the November 29 deadline, and what to do with product you can't sell.

DEA-REGISTERED REVERSE DISTRIBUTOR | SCHEDULES 1–5 | NO CONTRACT | CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Easy Rx Cycle · DEA-registered controlled substance destruction
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WHAT CHANGED IN 2026

Your product is now a controlled substance.

DEA's final rule published **April 28, 2026** moved marijuana, marijuana extract and naturally-derived delta-9-THC handled under a **state medical marijuana license** into **Schedule III**. Adult-use product was not rescheduled and stays in Schedule I. This guide covers medical product.

Schedule III

Medical product, extracts and naturally-derived THC are controlled substances.

DEA registration

Oct 30, 2026: 900+ dispensaries registered in AL, FL, MS, SD, TX, VA and WV. About 6,000 more are timely applicants.

November 29

Timely applicants must have every trading partner verified and compliant supply chains in place.

Who this applies to

- **DEA-registered dispensaries**, plus each new batch DEA approves.
- **Timely applicants**: operators that applied with fee between April 28 and June 26, 2026. They may keep operating under their state license while DEA reviews them.
- **Manufacturers and distributors**, still under review with inspections and quota decisions ahead.

The records you now keep

DEA's guidance says registrants handling Schedule III medical marijuana must keep all records required for Schedule III controlled substances under **21 CFR Part 1304**: an initial inventory, a biennial inventory, and a record of every receipt, sale and disposal, kept for two years.

Disposal is where new registrants get caught out. Product that leaves inventory without a record looks like a loss, and a significant loss must be reported on DEA Form 106.

Who you can deal with

Registrants and timely applicants may handle medical product **only with other registrants and timely applicants**, and must keep records of the checks behind each relationship. That includes whoever takes your product for destruction. For a DEA registrant, DEA lists a copy of its certificate of registration as part of adequate due diligence.

> **Tip** — Your state program's tracking and reporting rules still apply. Disposal has to reconcile in your federal records and your state system.

WASTE STREAM 01

Schedule III medical cannabis product

Product you can't sell. It's controlled-substance inventory, so it leaves the way a pharmacy's expired controls do.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
• Expired and out-of-date product • Failed-testing and quarantined batches • Recalled product and customer returns • Damaged product and broken packaging • Discontinued SKUs and dead inventory	• Extraction solvents (stream 02) • Vape hardware and batteries (stream 03) • Adult-use (Schedule I) product

THE RULE · 21 CFR Part 1304 records; transfer to a DEA-registered reverse distributor, which destroys the product to DEA's non-retrievable standard and completes DEA Form 41.

DISPOSE WITH · The Controlled Substance Mail-Back Kit: list the product, ship prepaid, we incinerate it and send your Certificate of Destruction. Schedule III transfers are documented with an invoice or transfer record; no DEA Form 222.

> **Tip** — File the transfer record and Certificate of Destruction together, and use them to close the product out in your state tracking system.

WASTE STREAM 02

Hazardous chemical waste

Extraction and processing chemicals.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
• Spent extraction solvents (ethanol, etc.) • Processing and lab chemicals • Characteristic hazardous chemicals	• Cannabis product (stream 01) • Sharps • Biohazard / red-bag waste

THE RULE · EPA RCRA and DOT: characterize, segregate by compatibility, manifest, and destroy at a permitted facility.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous handling with manifests.

> **Tip** — Characterize your chemicals first. The RCRA listing or characteristic sets the disposal path.

WASTE STREAM 03

Vape hardware and battery waste

Cartridges, pens and batteries that are e-waste or universal waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM	DOES NOT GO HERE
• Empty vape cartridges and pens • Lithium batteries • Damaged vape hardware	• Cannabis product (stream 01) • General trash

THE RULE · EPA universal-waste and e-waste rules: batteries and electronics are diverted from the trash and handled correctly.

DISPOSE WITH · Universal-waste / e-waste handling.

> **Tip** — Lithium batteries are a fire risk in a compactor or hauler truck. Segregate them at the source.

YOUR NOVEMBER 29 FILE

Verify your destruction partner

DEA's timely applicant guidance lists these minimum steps for confirming a partner:

Partner type	Collect
DEA registrant (e.g. a reverse distributor)	Copy of its DEA certificate of registration
Timely applicant dispensary	Its DEA dispensary submission confirmation, with the document control number (DCN) verified on DEA's site
Timely applicant manufacturer or distributor	Its DEA submission confirmation, with the DCN verified
Every partner	Copy of its state license, verified active, and a record of your checks

> **Need it on file?** — Ask for our DEA verification packet: our DEA certificate of registration, W-9, a sample Certificate of Destruction and a due-diligence record page. We send it the same day.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The medical cannabis disposal checklist.

- [ ] Confirm your status: DEA registrant or timely applicant. Keep your DEA confirmation and document control number on file.
- [ ] Take an initial inventory of medical product if you haven't.
- [ ] Set up Part 1304 records for every receipt, sale and disposal, kept for two years.
- [ ] Verify every trading partner by November 29, 2026, including your destruction partner, and keep the records.
- [ ] Move expired, damaged, recalled and returned product to a DEA-registered reverse distributor on a schedule. Quarterly auto-ship keeps it from piling up.
- [ ] File every Certificate of Destruction with its transfer record.
- [ ] Close destroyed product out in your state tracking system.
- [ ] Route extraction solvents to RCRA-hazardous handling with manifests.
- [ ] Divert vape hardware and batteries to universal-waste handling.
- [ ] Re-verify partners when their DEA status changes from applicant to registrant.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Do I need a DEA Form 222 to send product for destruction? No. Form 222 is for Schedules I and II. Schedule III transfers are documented with an invoice or transfer record.

Who completes DEA Form 41? The reverse distributor that destroys the product. You keep the transfer record and Certificate of Destruction.

Can a timely applicant use a reverse distributor? Yes. DEA's guidance lets timely applicants handle Schedule III medical marijuana with DEA registrants.

Does this replace my state rules? No. State tracking and reporting rules still apply alongside DEA's.

QUICK REFERENCE

Which path for which stream.

Waste stream	The right path
Medical cannabis product (Schedule III)	Controlled Substance Mail-Back Kit to a DEA-registered reverse distributor
Extraction solvents and chemicals	RCRA-hazardous handling, manifested
Vape hardware and batteries	Universal-waste / e-waste handling
Clinical sharps (if any)	Sharps mail-back kit

CONTROLLED SUBSTANCE MAIL-BACK KIT

Priced by weight. No contract.

Kit size	One-time	Auto-ship (save 20%)
Up to 5 lbs	$499	$399
Up to 10 lbs	$599	$479
Up to 20 lbs	$1,199	$959
Up to 100 lbs	$1,999	$1,599

Every kit: prepaid shipping both ways, destruction by incineration, DEA Form 41 completed by us, and a Certificate of Destruction.

Order a kit, or request the verification packet.

easyrxcycle.com/who-we-serve/cannabis · 501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com
Multiple locations? Call for program pricing.

Easy Rx Cycle is a DEA-registered reverse distributor serving all 50 states. This guide is general information based on DEA's April 28, 2026 final rule and October 30, 2026 timely applicant guidance; it is not legal advice.